ENGLISH

STUDY GUIDE • 7th GRADE

Prova de Inglês — 13/11

Medieval Towns • Simple Past • Before/After • Past Continuous • Can/Could



1	**Reading** Medieval Towns & The Dark Ages	Módulo 13	
2	**Simple Past** Affirmative, negative & interrogative	Módulo 12	
3	**Connectors** Before & After	Módulo 15	
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5	**Modal verbs** can – can't – could – couldn't	Módulo 17	

Good luck on your test!

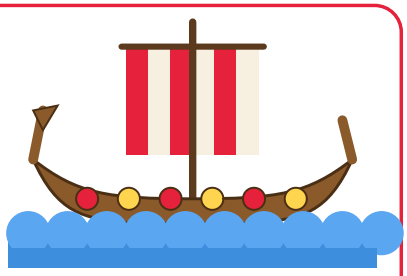
Medieval Towns & The Dark Ages

Módulo 13

Look! What were the Dark Ages?

The **Dark Ages** is a name for the **early Middle Ages** in Europe: the time **after the fall of the Roman Empire** (year 476) until about the year 1000.

Life was hard: many people lived in **small villages**, there were many wars and **Vikings** and **Saxons** arrived by ship. Today, historians prefer *Early Middle Ages* because there was also art, religion and trade.



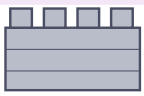


A medieval town: castle, walls, houses, market, windmill and a river port.

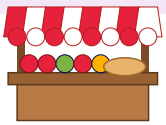
Vocabulary — medieval words



castle
castelo



walls
muralhas



market
mercado / feira



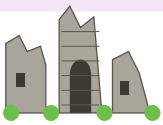
to trade
comerciar



grain
grão / cereal



river port
porto fluvial



priory
priorado (mosteiro)



battle
batalha



railway
ferrovia



town hall
prefeitura



windmill
moinho de vento



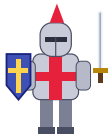
borough
município

Look! Who lived in a medieval town?

The **king** ruled the country.



The **knights** fought and protected.



The **peasants** worked on the land.



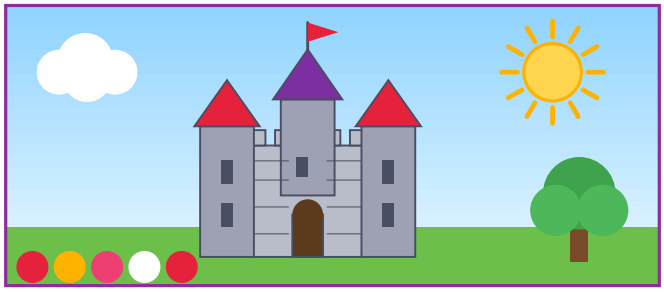
The **monks** prayed and studied.



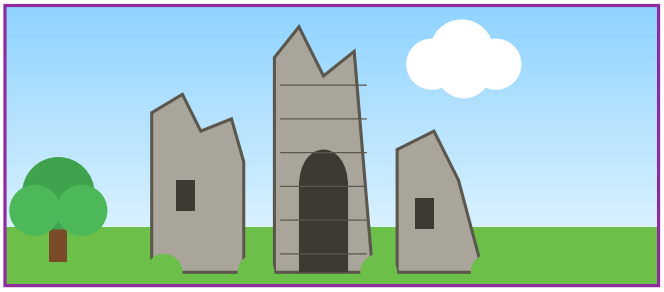
Case study: the history of Lewes

Módulo 13

Lewes is a **medieval town** in **East Sussex, England**. Look at how it changed over time. This is the kind of information you must find in the text.



Lewes Castle in Lewes, East Sussex, England.

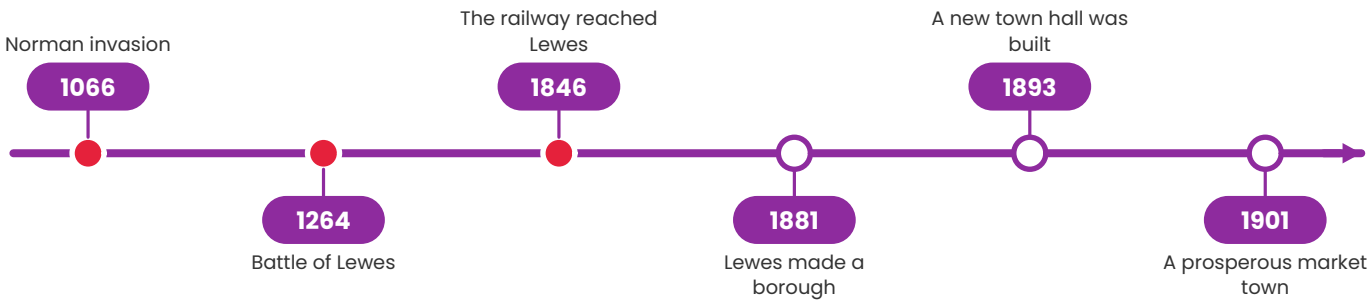


The ruins of St Pancras Priory in Lewes, East Sussex.

Lewes through time

Time period	Characteristics of the town	Importance
Saxon (6th century)	• Weekly markets • River port • A village that grew to be a town	• People traded things every week • They sent out grain and goods to other places
Norman (11th century)	• Norman invasion in **1066** • Priory of St Pancras • Castle	• It kept the town safe • A special place for religion • A big historical event
13th century	• **1264**: Battle of Lewes • King Henry III fought rebellious barons (Second Barons' War)	• A famous battle in English history
17th–18th centuries	• Lewes became a **county town** • New industries	• The town made important decisions • More and different jobs
19th century	• Arrival of **trains** (railway) • Lewes became a **borough** • Population grew	• Easier to transport goods • Own local government • More people came; the town became busier

Important dates



Red dot = date sure from the activity/text. **White dot** = confirme a ordem exata no texto da sua apostila.

Reading tips for the test

1. Read the questions first. **2.** Skim (read fast) to get the main idea. **3.** Scan for dates, names and numbers. **4.** Look for cognates: *invasion*, *industry*, *prosperous*. **5.** Answer with the information from the text, not from memory.

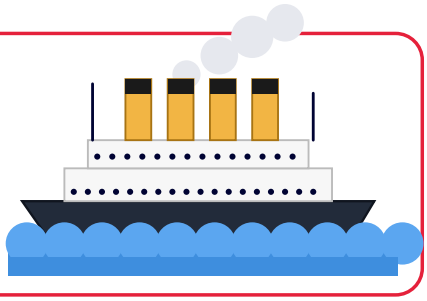
The simple past tense: regular verbs

Módulo 12

Look! When do we use the simple past?

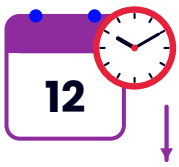
We use the **simple past** to talk about a **completed action** that happened or existed in the **past** (recent or distant).

Regular verbs: **subject + verb + -ed**.
The Titanic **sailed** in 1912. People **traded** in the weekly market.



Time markers that indicate the past

A word	Ago	Before	Last	In + year
yesterday	days ago months ago years ago	the day before the month before the year before	last night last week last year	in 1066 in 1264 in 1846



Spelling rules for regular verbs

1 Most verbs: + **-ed**

work – **worked**
watch – **watched**
play – **played**



2 Verbs ending in **-e**: + **-d**

live – **lived**
create – **created**
like – **liked**



3 Consonant + **y**: drop **-y** and add **-ied**

study – **studied**
carry – **carried**
cry – **cried**



4 1 vowel + 1 consonant: **double** the consonant + **-ed**

stop – **stopped**
plan – **planned**
(play = **played**, not w/x/y)



How do we say the -ed ending?

/t/

worked, watched, stopped, helped, washed

/d/

played, lived, called, opened, studied

/id/

wanted, needed, started, decided, visited



Quick check!

1) Write the past form: **stop** = _____ **live** = _____ **study** = _____

play = _____ **visit** = _____ **carry** = _____

2) Which sound? (/t/, /d/ or /id/): **watched** _____ **wanted** _____ **called** _____

The simple past tense: irregular verbs

Módulo 13

Look! Irregular verbs

An **irregular verb** does **not** form the simple past with **-ed**. Each verb has its own past form, so you need to **memorize** them.

I **drive** every day. I **drove** yesterday. | The Saxon village **grew** to be a town.



Base form	Simple past	Português
be	**was / were**	ser / estar
begin	**began**	começar
break	**broke**	quebrar
build	**built**	construir
buy	**bought**	comprar
come	**came**	vir
do	**did**	fazer
draw	**drew**	desenhar
drive	**drove**	dirigir
eat	**ate**	comer
fight	**fought**	lutar
find	**found**	encontrar
fly	**flew**	voar
get	**got**	conseguir
give	**gave**	dar
go	**went**	ir

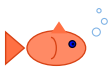
Base form	Simple past	Português
grow	**grew**	crescer
have	**had**	ter
hear	**heard**	ouvir
know	**knew**	saber
leave	**left**	sair / deixar
make	**made**	fazer
meet	**met**	encontrar
read	**read***	ler
run	**ran**	correr
say	**said**	dizer
see	**saw**	ver
sing	**sang**	cantar
sleep	**slept**	dormir
swim	**swam**	nadar
take	**took**	pegar / levar
write	**wrote**	escrever

** read (past) is written the same, but pronounced /red/.*

Memory tricks: verbs that change in a pattern

i to a

sing – sang
swim – swam
begin – began
run – ran



-ought / -aught

buy – bought
fight – fought
think – thought
teach – taught



-ew

fly – flew
grow – grew
know – knew
draw – drew



Same form!

cut – cut
put – put
hit – hit
read – read



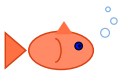
Irregular verbs in pictures



eat
ate



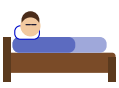
fly
flew



swim
swam



drive
drove



sleep
slept



build
built



buy
bought



ride
rode



Also remember:

become – **became** • wake – **woke** • speak – **spoke** • win – **won** • tell – **told** • lose – **lost** • send – **sent** • pay – **paid** • sell – **sold** • cut – **cut**

Simple past: affirmative, negative, interrogative

Módulo 12

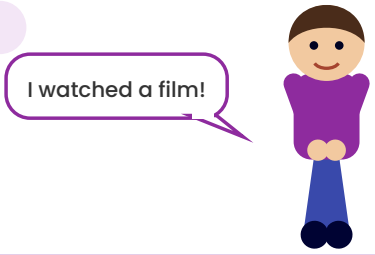
+ AFFIRMATIVE

Subject + **verb in the past**

I **watched** a film yesterday.

She **went** to school by bus.

The Saxons **traded** grain.



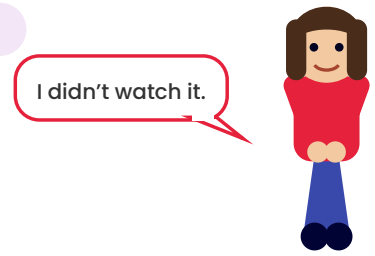
− NEGATIVE

Subject + **did not (didn't)** + **base verb**

I **didn't watch** a film yesterday.

She **didn't go** to school by bus.

They **didn't live** there.



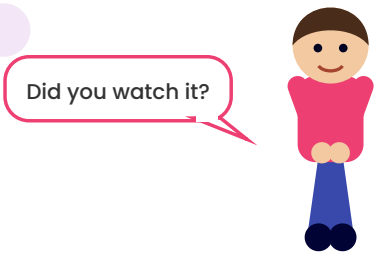
? INTERROGATIVE

Did + subject + **base verb** ?

Did you **watch** a film? Yes, I **did**.

Did she **go** by bus? No, she **didn't**.

Where did they **live**?



Question words (wh-questions)

What?	Where?	When?	Who?	Why?	How?
o quê	*onde*	*quando*	*quem*	*por quê*	*como*
What did you do?	Where did he go?	When did it happen?	Who built the castle?	Why did they leave?	How did you get here?

Look! After did / didn't the verb goes back to the base form

✗ She didn't ~~went~~ to school.

✗ Did you ~~watched~~ TV?

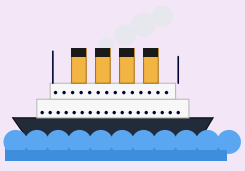
✓ She didn't **go** to school.

✓ Did you **watch** TV?

Verb TO BE in the past (no "did"!)

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I / he / she / it **was** you / we / they **were**	I / he / she / it **wasn't** you / we / they **weren't**	**Was** she a student? Yes, she **was**. **Were** you there? No, I **wasn't**.

The Titanic **was** a big ship. The passengers **weren't** afraid at first.



Connectors: before & after

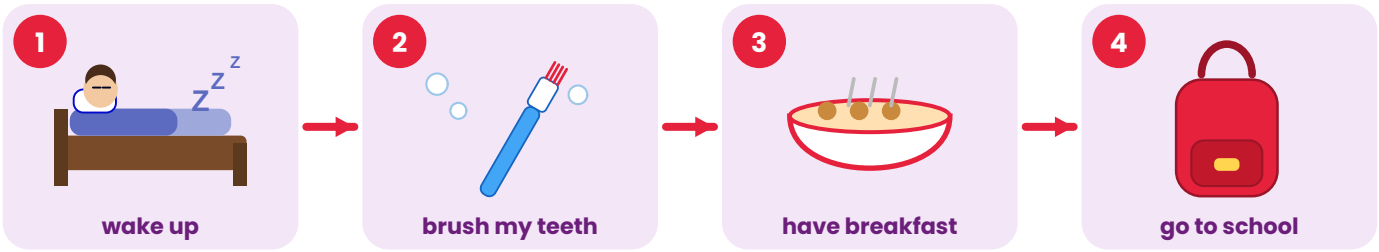
Módulo 15

Look! Before and after

Before = antes (de) | **After** = depois (de)

They are **connectors** that show the **order** of two actions. The action with **after** happens **first**; the action with **before** happens **second**.

My morning routine



Same meaning, two ways

BEFORE

I **brush** my teeth **before** I **have** breakfast.

= Before I have breakfast, I brush my teeth.

AFTER

I **have** breakfast **after** I **brush** my teeth.

= After I brush my teeth, I have breakfast.

Comma rule: connector at the **beginning** = use a **comma** (*After I eat, I study.*). Connector in the **middle** = **no comma** (*I study after I eat.*).
Use the **same tense** in both parts of the sentence: *Before she **went** to bed, she **brushed** her teeth.*

What comes after before / after?

Structure	Example
before / after + **subject + verb**	I wash my hands **before** I eat.
before / after + **verb-ing**	**After** eating, I brush my teeth. / **Before** going to bed, she reads.
before / after + **noun**	We play football **after** class. / Wash your hands **before** lunch.

Back to Lewes!

Before the Normans came, Lewes was a Saxon town.
The Normans invaded England in 1066. **After** the invasion, they built a castle.
After the trains arrived, more people came and the town became busier.



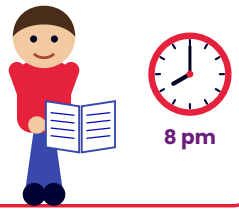
The past continuous

Módulo 16

Look! When do we use the past continuous?

We use it for an action that was **in progress** (happening) at a specific moment in the past.

Form: **subject + was / were + verb-ing**



Subject	Was / Were	Example
I / he / she / it	**was**	At 8 pm yesterday, I **was studying**.
you / we / they	**were**	They **were playing** football at 5 o'clock.

Three main uses



1 Action in progress at a specific time

At 7 o'clock, she **was having** dinner.



2 Two actions at the same time (while)

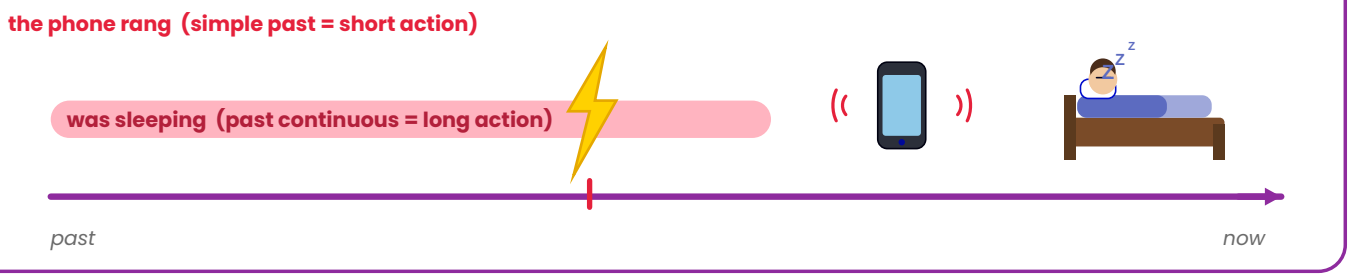
While I **was cooking**, my brother **was playing** football.



3 Interrupted action (when + simple past)

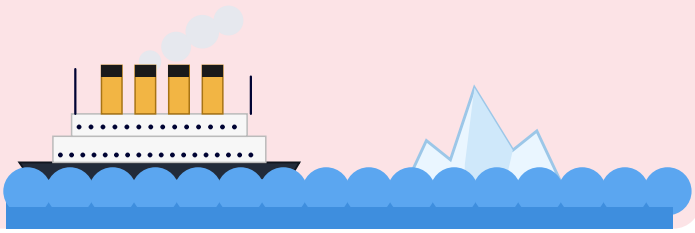
I **was sleeping** when the phone **rang**.

The long action and the interruption



WHILE or WHEN?

while + past continuous (the long action)
when + simple past (the short action)
The Titanic **was sailing** when it **hit** an iceberg.



Past continuous: negative, questions & spelling

Módulo 16

+ AFFIRMATIVE

Subject + **was / were** + **verb-ing**

She **was reading** a book.
They **were playing** football.



− NEGATIVE

Subject + **wasn't / weren't** + **verb-ing**

She **wasn't reading** a book.
They **weren't playing** football.



? INTERROGATIVE

Was / Were + subject + **verb-ing** ?

Was she **reading**? Yes, she **was**. / No, she **wasn't**.
What were you **doing** at 8 pm?



Spelling: verb + -ing

Most verbs: + **-ing**	Ends in **-e**: drop the **e**	1 vowel + 1 consonant: **double**	Ends in **-ie**: change **ie** to **y**
play – **playing** work – **working**	make – **making** write – **writing**	run – **running** swim – **swimming** stop – **stopping**	lie – **lying** die – **dying**

What were they doing?



He **was playing** football.



She **was reading** a book.



They **were riding** bikes.



He **was playing** the piano.

Simple past × Past continuous

Simple past	Past continuous
finished action: I **watched** a film.	action in progress: I **was watching** a film.
short action: the phone **rang**.	long action: I **was sleeping**.

Time markers: at 8 pm, at that moment, all day yesterday, while, when.
Careful: we usually do not use the continuous with *know, like, love, want, need* (I **knew** the answer).

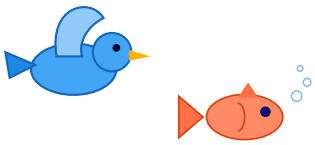
Can – can't – could – couldn't

Módulo 17

Look! Modal verbs

Can and **could** are **modal verbs**. They are the **same for all persons** (no -s), and the next verb is in the **base form** (no *to*).

Form: **subject + can / can't / could / couldn't + base verb**



Four forms, four meanings

CAN — ability now / permission

I **can** swim.
Can I go out, please?




CAN'T — inability / prohibition

I **can't** fly.
You **can't** park here.



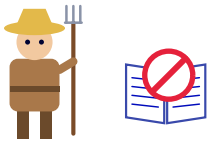
COULD — ability in the past / polite request

When I was five, I **could** ride a bike.
Could you help me, please?



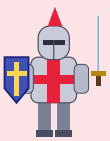
COULDN'T — inability in the past

The peasants **couldn't** read.
I **couldn't** swim last year.



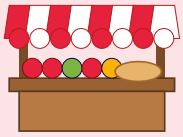
Questions and short answers

Question	Short answers
Can you swim?	Yes, I **can**. / No, I **can't**.
Could you ride a bike when you were five?	Yes, I **could**. / No, I **couldn't**.
What **could** knights do?	They **could** fight on horses.



In the Middle Ages...

Knights **could** fight on horses. Peasants **couldn't** read or write.
In Lewes, people **could** trade at the weekly market. They **couldn't** travel by train.



Look! Common mistakes

- ✗ She ~~cans~~ swim.
- ✗ Can she ~~to swim~~?
- ✗ He ~~could to~~ run fast.

- ✓ She **can** swim.
- ✓ Can she **swim**?
- ✓ He **could run** fast.

can't = cannot (one word)

Exercises (do it before the test!)

1 Simple past — complete with the past form.

go • watch • build • eat

a) Yesterday I _____ a film.

b) She _____ to school by bus.

c) The Normans _____ a castle.

d) We _____ pizza last night.



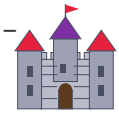
2 Make negative (–) or question (?).

a) He played football. (–)
_____

b) They lived in Lewes. (?)
_____

c) She wrote an email. (–)
_____

d) You saw the castle. (?)
_____



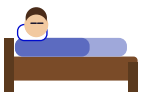
3 Complete with before or after.

a) I brush my teeth _____ I go to bed.

b) We have lunch _____ class.

c) 1. wake up 2. breakfast
I wake up _____ I have breakfast.

d) _____ the trains arrived, Lewes got busier.



4 Past continuous — use the verb in brackets.

a) At 9 pm I _____ (study).

b) She _____ (sleep) when the phone rang.

c) They _____ (not play) football.

d) _____ you _____ (watch) TV?



5 Complete with can, can't, could or couldn't.

a) Birds _____ fly.

b) When I was a baby, I _____ walk.

c) _____ you help me, please?

d) In the Middle Ages, peasants _____ read.



6 Lewes — True (T) or False (F)?

( ) Lewes is a town in East Sussex, England.

( ) The Battle of Lewes took place in 1264.

( ) The Saxons built the Priory of St Pancras.

( ) After the railway, more people came to Lewes.



Last-minute cheat sheet

Topic	Structure	Example
Simple past regular	Subject + verb-**ed**	We **watched** a film. / She **studied** a lot.
Simple past irregular	Subject + 2nd form (memorize!)	I **went** home. / They **built** a castle.
Negative	Subject + **didn't** + base verb	I **didn't go**. / He **didn't build** it.
Question	**Did** + subject + base verb?	**Did** you **see** it? Yes, I **did**.
Verb to be past	**was / were** — **wasn't / weren't**	**Was** she there? She **wasn't**.
Before / After	**before** = 2nd action **after** = 1st action	I eat **after** I study. / **Before** eating, I wash my hands.
Past continuous	**was / were** + verb-**ing**	I **was sleeping** when the phone **rang**.
While / When	**while** + continuous **when** + simple past	**While** I **was cooking**, he **was playing**.
Can / can't	ability / permission now	I **can** swim. / You **can't** park here.
Could / couldn't	ability in the past / polite request	I **could** ride a bike at 5. / **Could** you help me?

Remember the time markers

Simple past
yesterday • ago • last week • in 1066

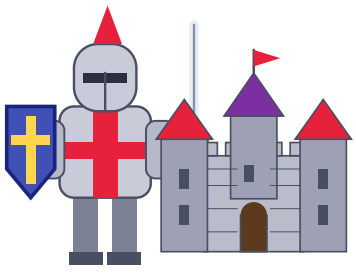


Past continuous
at 8 pm • while • at that moment



Test-day checklist

- Read each question twice.
- After **did / didn't**: base form!
- Check **was / were** with the subject.
- Use a **comma** if the sentence starts with before / after.
- Reading: find dates, names and numbers in the text.



Answer key

Try the exercises first, then check your answers here.

1 Exercise 1

a) watched
b) went
c) built
d) ate

2 Exercise 2

a) He didn't play football.
b) Did they live in Lewes?
c) She didn't write an email.
d) Did you see the castle?

3 Exercise 3

a) before
b) after
c) before
d) After

4 Exercise 4

a) was studying
b) was sleeping
c) weren't playing
d) Were … watching

5 Exercise 5

a) can
b) couldn't
c) Could / Can
d) couldn't

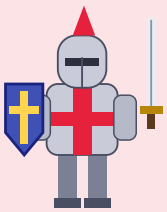
6 Exercise 6

T
T
F (the Normans built it)
T

Quick check (page 4): stopped • lived • studied • played • visited • carried. **Sounds:** watched /t/ • wanted /id/ • called /d/.

Lewes: match the date (check with your text)

Date	Event
1066	The Norman invasion happened.
1264	The Battle of Lewes took place.
1846	The railway reached Lewes.
1881 / 1893 / 1901	Lewes was made a borough • A new town hall was built • Lewes was a prosperous market town Confirm the exact order in your workbook text.



You can do it!

Study a little every day and good luck on the test!

